



CALICUT UNIVERSITY – FOUR-YEAR UNDERGRADUATE PROGRAMME (CU-FYUGP)

GENERAL FOUNDATION COURSES

FOUNDATION COURSE FOR HUMANITIES AND OTHER BA PROGRAMMES

SKILL ENHANCEMENT COURSE (SEC)

Programme	GENERAL FOUNDATION COURSES IN ENGLISH					
Course Code	ENG4FS111(1B)					
Course Title	CONTEMPORARY LANGUAGE SKILLS FOR HUMANITIES AND OTHER BA PROGRAMMES					
Type of Course	SKILL ENHANCEMENT COURSE (SEC) – HUMANITIES					
Semester	4					
Academic Level	100-199					
Course Details	Credits	Lecture	Tutorial	Practical	Others	Total Hours
	3	2	-	2	-	60
Pre-requisites	Basic English Language Comprehension and Analytical skills.					
Course Summary	The course equips the learners in developing skills to use English as a medium of effective communication in their professional contexts and also provides insights about how to show creativity through language, how to enhance clarity in expression and how to make communication impactful.					

Course Outcomes (CO):

CO	CO Statement	Cognitive Level*	Knowledge Category#	Evaluation Tools used
CO1	Demonstrate proficiency in contemporary language skills suitable for academic and professional contexts.	R, U	F, C	Comprehension/GD
CO2	Understand and appreciate the cultural nuances embedded in the language.	R, Ap, An,	C, P	Debates
CO3	Apply critical thinking skills to analyze and interpret various forms of contemporary language media, such as literature, films, articles, and online content.	Ap, An	P, M	Discussions/Review
CO4	Communicate effectively and coherently in both written and spoken forms of the contemporary language.	E, C	F, M	Assignments
CO5	Apply language skills across interdisciplinary contexts within the humanities and beyond, integrating knowledge from other disciplines.	Ap	P	Discussions/exam
CO6	Foster a critical attitude to analyse and comprehend the judicious use of English language.	An	M	Discussion/Assignment
* - Remember (R), Understand (U), Apply (Ap), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C) # - Factual Knowledge(F) Conceptual Knowledge (C) Procedural Knowledge (P) Metacognitive Knowledge (M)				

Detailed Syllabus:

Module	Unit	Content	Hrs (60)	Marks (50)
I	SOCIAL & PROFESSIONAL SKILLS		8	10
	Skill: To develop effective communication, teamwork, and leadership abilities to excel in both social and professional environments.			
	1	Emotional Intelligence in the Workplace- Ivan Andreev https://www.valamis.com/hub/emotional-intelligence-in-the-workplace	2	
	2	Philosophy is the secret to thriving in the age of AI- Jim Frawley https://www.fastcompany.com/90935547/we-need-more-workers-studying-philosophy-not-computer-science-to-address-the-disruption-of-ai	2	
	3	Full Address- BBC Panel discussion- Stephen Fry https://youtu.be/IporlmXXDeY?si=0kW6_Srb7KSnNmBd	2	
	4	The Story Behind the Story- Who moved my cheese? - Spencer Johnson (P.13-18)		
II	Critical Thinking & Problem Solving		8	15
	Skill: To enable learners how to think and evaluate critically.			
	5	The Black Sheep- Italo Calvino	2	
	6	The Five Orange Pips- Sir Arthur Conan Doyle	2	
	7	Children of the Working Class- John Wieners	2	
	8	Build a tower, Build a Team -Tom Wujec https://youtu.be/H0_yKBitO8M?si=Ds1RNNabxo27o6of	2	

III	Creative Expressions		7	15
	Skills: To enable learners to master the nuances of creative writing and understand the fundamental elements of creative writing by developing skills in writing fiction, poetry, and creative non-fiction.			
	9	Sunflowers - Vincent Van Gogh	1	
	10	Tyger-William Blake	2	
	11	Kurt Vonnegut on the Shapes of Stories - David Comberg https://youtu.be/oP3c1h8v2ZQ?si=Ah9LQXlO0kNtU1Bg	2	
	12	The Knife: Meditations after an Attempted Murder-Salman Rushdie (Part 1-The Knife, pp 7-15)	2	
IV	Collaboration		7	10
	Skills: To teach learners the skill of collaboration in classroom-Brainstorming, Group Discussion & Peer Learning Collaborative in the digital spaces.			
	13	Documentary based on Kerala flood- https://youtu.be/kwwhq1IOIE?si=Z6rCDbHx5tW3iJpU	2	
	14	Empowering India's Women through Community Groups -P Sainath https://www.bbc.com/news/world-asia-india-27615599	2	
	15	The New Science of Building Great Teams - Alex Pentland https://hbr.org/2012/04/the-new-science-of-building-great-teams	2	
	16	Theme for English B- Langston Hughes	1	
V	Practicum		30	

		Module I: 1. Prepare daily or weekly journal on your emotional responses to various situations. 2. Conduct a group discussion on how emotions are managed in different situations. 3. Conduct debates on ethical dilemmas related to AI, such as privacy, decision-making, and the impact of automation on employment. 4. Make a report on moral dilemmas related to AI, such as the development of autonomous weapons or AI in healthcare and use philosophical reasoning to explore potential solutions. 5. Prepare seminars presentation elaborating the themes discussed by Fry, providing additional insights and facilitating discussions on how these themes impact various fields. 6. Read books and articles related to the topics discussed by Fry and prepare a note. 7. Divide participants into groups and assign each group one of the characters from the book. Have each group discuss how their character's behavior relates to real-life responses to change in a workplace or personal setting. 8. Create and share stories about how learners have navigated change, using the format of "Who Moved My Cheese?" for inspiration.	8	
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		Module II: 1. Write short stories or essays from the perspective of different characters in <i>The Black Sheep</i>. Explore how each character perceives the protagonist and the central conflict. 2. Analyze the symbolism of the black sheep and other elements in the story. Discuss how Calvino uses symbolism to convey deeper meanings and relate these symbols to contemporary issues. 3. Write a short story or journal entry from the perspective of a minor character in “The Five Orange Pips.” Explore how their viewpoint might offer new insights into the mystery. 4. Discuss the themes of justice, revenge, and the supernatural in the story. Explore how these themes are portrayed and their significance in the context of the narrative. 5. Discuss the socioeconomic challenges faced by the working class both historically and in contemporary contexts. Relate these challenges to the experiences depicted in the book. 6. Explore how different media (film, documentaries, music) represent working-class experiences and compare these portrayals to Wieners' work. 7. Conduct a discussion focusing on develop collaboration and communication skills. 8. Analyze unsuccessful attempts in collaborative projects from their studies and discuss the lessons that can be learned from those experiences.	7	
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		Module III: 1. Discuss a brief history of Vincent van Gogh and his <i>Sunflowers</i> series, his techniques, influences, and the significance of the paintings within his body of work. 2. Research and discuss other artists who influenced Van Gogh or were influenced by his work. Explore how <i>Sunflowers</i> fits into the broader art movements of his time. 3. Analyze the symbolism of the tiger in Blake's poem. Discuss the imagery used and how it contributes to the poem's themes and overall impact. 4. Create short skits or scenes that adapt the themes and imagery of <i>The Tyger</i>. 5. Create plot diagrams for well-known stories or personal narratives, using Vonnegut's shapes of stories as a guide. 6. Analyze how different genres use story shapes. Compare how traditional genres like mystery or romance differ in their narrative structures compared to experimental or avant-garde genres. 7. Discuss the main themes presented in this section, such as fear, survival, and resilience. Explore how Rushdie addresses these themes through his personal reflections. 8. Write a personal reflection or essay inspired by the themes of <i>The Knife</i>. Explore how facing personal challenges or fears has influenced your own life and thoughts.	8	
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		Module IV: 1. Hold a group discussion or reflective session on the key themes of the documentary, such as the causes of the flood, its impact on communities, and the response efforts. Explore how the documentary portrays these issues. 2. Investigate and present on disaster management practices and strategies employed in Kerala during and after the flood. Compare these with practices in other regions affected by similar disasters. 3. Conduct seminars on gender equality and women's rights, using examples from community groups highlighted in the article. Include discussions on challenges and solutions. 4. Create a documentary or short film that highlights the stories of women involved in community groups. Use interviews and personal narratives to showcase their impact and achievements. 5. Analyze the correlation between communication patterns and team performance. Identify trends and insights that can inform strategies for improving team effectiveness. 6. Discuss on effective communication strategies and how to foster a positive team culture. Include topics such as active listening, empathy, and conflict resolution. 7. Prepare a report on themes of race, identity, and social justice after conducting a GD. 8. Group presentations on the topics discussed in the modules given above.	7	
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Note: The course is divided into five modules, with four having 16 fixed units and one open-ended module with a variable number of units. There are total 30 transaction hours for the fixed modules and 30 hours for the open ended one. Internal assessments (25 marks) as split between the open-ended module (15 Marks) and the fixed modules (10 Marks). The final exam, however, covers only the 16 units from the fixed modules.

Suggested Reading:

1. Anderson, Chris J. TED TALKS: The Official TED Guide to Public Speaking. Canada, HarperCollins, 2017.
2. Balasubramaniam, T A *Textbook of English Phonetics for Indian Learners*. Macmillan, 2013.
3. Beck, Isabel L., et al. *Bringing Words to Life: Robust Vocabulary Instruction*. United States, Guilford Publications, 2013.
4. Bowe, Heather, et al. *Communication Across Cultures: Mutual Understanding in a Global World*. Australia, Cambridge University Press, 2014.
5. Get Out
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Jdd0JF79q4I> (Video Essay on racism)
6. How to give effective feedback
<https://www.cultureamp.com/blog/how-to-give-effective-feedback>